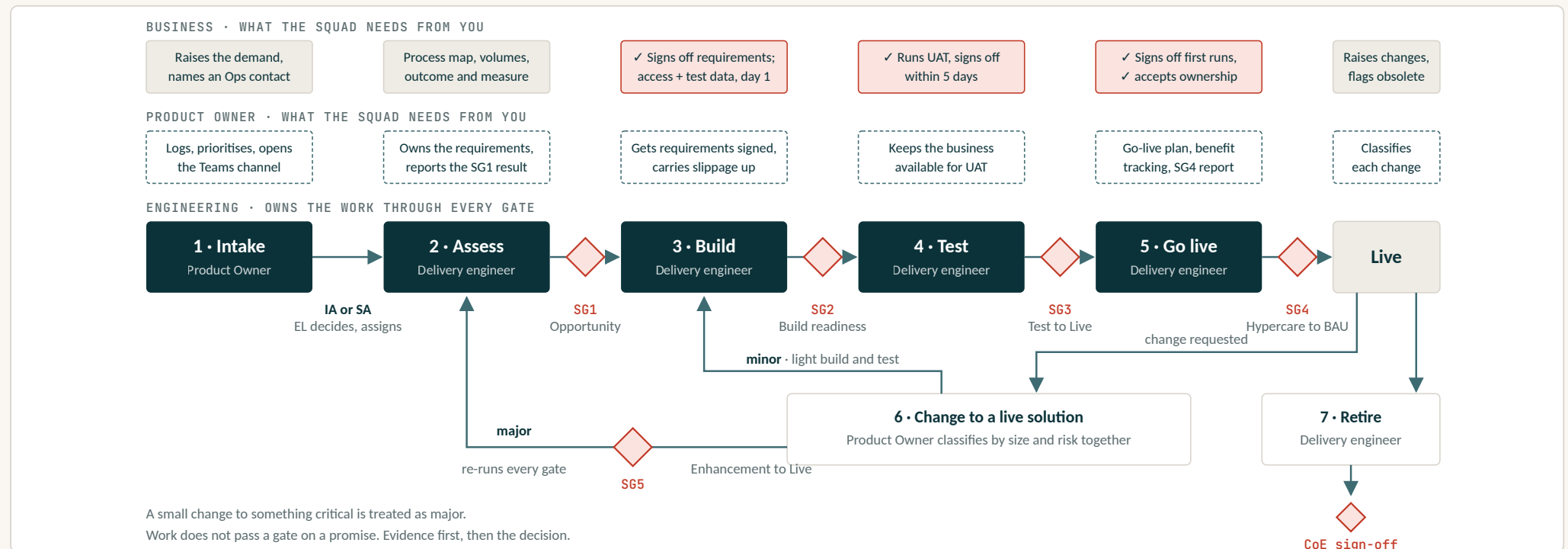


How we deliver automation

Every request goes through the same **five steps**, whether it is Intelligent Automation (RPA) or Smart Automation (Power Platform). Each step has **one owner** and ends at a **CoE gate**. The Product Owner owns demand. A named delivery engineer owns getting the work through the gates. The route changes how heavy the gate is. It never changes the steps.

The whole journey

Left to right for a new solution. The two rows above the spine are what the business and the Product Owner owe the squad at each step, so engineering can deliver without chasing. A live solution loops back in for a change, or exits through retirement.



◇ **CoE gate.** The delivery engineer submits, the CoE decides. □ **Business sign-off.** Four of them: requirements before build, UAT before SG3, first runs before anything scales, ownership before SG4.

IA runs the full gate at every step. **SA** runs the same steps with a lighter check: a register entry instead of a full opportunity case, and proportionate evidence at each gate.

Who does what, and by when

Each step in order. Timings are the standard we hold ourselves to, in working days. Anything that misses one is raised at the next daily sync.

STEP 1

Intake

Owner: **Product Owner**

Done when the request is logged, routed, sized, and has a named Ops contact and a named delivery engineer.

No gate. Nothing starts without this step.

1	Business raises the demand, with its context, and names an Ops contact.	Same day
2	Product Owner logs it, confirms the outcome and priority, and passes it for routing.	Within 1 day
3	Engineers give current platform capability and squad capacity.	Before the route is set
4	Engineering Lead decides IA or SA on technical grounds, names the delivery engineer who will own it, and tells the PO and the business. Engineers set the provisional size and the risk flag.	Within 2 days
5	Product Owner adds it to the pipeline and opens the Teams channel with the pinned post.	Next daily sync

STEP 2

Assess

Owner: **Delivery engineer**

Done when the CoE approves the case (IA) or the register entry is complete (SA), the process map is in hand and the size is confirmed.

SG1 • Opportunity Assessment

1	Business walks the squad through the current process and provides the process map, volumes, exceptions and the systems touched.	Before the case is built
2	Product Owner confirms the business outcome, benefit owner and success measure, and owns the requirements from here on.	Before the case is built
3	Engineers assess platform fit, data, connectors and access, and produce an indicative breakdown with the size it supports.	Before submission
4	Engineering Lead confirms the technology choice and architecture fit, and unblocks anything the squad cannot reach on its own.	Before submission
5	Delivery engineer submits the SG1 opportunity case (IA) or completes the register entry (SA).	At the gate
6	CoE returns the decision, with any conditions.	At the gate
7	Product Owner tells the business the outcome, the confirmed size and what happens next. A fail is escalated to leads.	Within 2 days of the decision

STEP 3

Build

Owner: **Delivery engineer**

Done when the build is complete and the charter, route-to-live material and test plan are ready.

SG2 • Build readiness

- | | | |
|---|---|----------------------------|
| 1 | Product Owner confirms the requirements and the to-be process with the business and raises the formal access request. | Within 2 days of SG1 |
| 2 | Business signs off the requirements and the process map. No sign-off, no build day one. | Before the first build day |
| 3 | Business grants system access, credentials and representative test data. | Before the first build day |
| 4 | Engineers break the work down, sequence it and estimate it against the confirmed size. | Before the first build day |
| 5 | Engineers build, and report progress, blockers and gaps first hand. The squad takes its own technical decisions.
Technical blockers and stack questions go to the Engineering Lead; scope, priority and business blockers go to the Product Owner. | Every day, at daily sync |
| 6 | Delivery engineer raises any slippage at the daily sync, and the Product Owner carries it to the feature sync. In the week it appears, not after. | That week after. |
| 7 | Delivery engineer submits SG2 with the charter and route-to-live material. | At the gate |

STEP 4

Test

Owner: **Delivery engineer**

Done when every test case has evidenced results, defects are triaged and the business has signed off UAT.

SG3 • Test to Live

- | | | |
|---|---|------------------------------|
| 1 | Engineers open the test cycle against the agreed test plan. | Immediately after SG2 |
| 2 | Engineers raise, triage and prioritise each defect. P1 and P2 go to leads with the date impact. | Same day it is found |
| 3 | Engineers assemble evidenced results against every test case. | Before UAT opens |
| 4 | Delivery engineer opens UAT with the business: scope, test data and sign-off criteria. | 3 days' notice, minimum |
| 5 | Business signs UAT off, or names the defects blocking it. | Within 5 days of UAT opening |
| 6 | Delivery engineer submits SG3 with the evidence and the UAT sign-off. | At the gate |

Go live

Owner: **Delivery engineer**

Done when every scenario has passed its first live run, hypercare has run its window with no P1 or P2 open, Ops own it and benefit tracking is live.

SG4 • Hypercare to BAU

1	Engineers list every in-scope scenario, with a named business validator for each.	Within 2 days of SG3
2	Product Owner issues the go-live plan: validator availability and what the business must do.	Before first-run checks open
3	Engineers run first-run checks (FOV) and report coverage: validated, outstanding, variants found. A failed scenario goes back to build the same day.	Every day until coverage is complete
4	Business signs FOV off once every scenario is validated and its output reconciled.	When coverage is complete
5	Engineers support hypercare for the window the size sets.	3 to 20 days by size
6	Business accepts operational ownership: Ops trained on the runbook and confident to run it.	Before hypercare closes
7	Delivery engineer submits SG4 with Ops ownership confirmed.	End of the hypercare window
8	Product Owner reports ownership confirmed and benefit tracking at planning and prioritisation.	Within 5 days of SG4

Who owns what

Business

Raises the need, provides the process map and volumes, grants access and test data. Gives four sign-offs: requirements, UAT, first runs, ownership. Owns and operates the solution once it is live.

Product Owner

Owns demand, value and priority. Accountable for intake and for classifying changes. Owns the Teams channel and every message to the business. First call for scope, priority and business blockers.

Engineering Lead

Owns technology choice and assignment. Decides the route and the stack for a problem, names the delivery engineer, settles technical decisions and architecture fit, and unblocks what the squad cannot reach: other tech teams, architecture, platforms. First call for technical blockers. Not accountable for getting work through the gates.

Engineers

Own the delivery. A named delivery engineer is accountable for each piece of work from assessment to retirement: sizes it, keeps it on track and submits every gate. Senior engineers are expected to know what the platforms can do and to make sound estimates.

CoE

Decides the gates. Consulted at every gate, never accountable for delivery.

One accountable owner per step. Never two, never none. The Product Owner for demand, the delivery engineer for delivery.

After go-live

A live solution is only touched through one of these two paths.

6 • Change to a live solution

Owner: **Product Owner** Gate: **SG5 • Enhancement to Live**, major only

- | | | |
|-------|--|------------------------------|
| 1 | Business raises the change, with the driver behind it. | Same day |
| <hr/> | | |
| 2 | Engineers give the technical impact, size advice and risk flag. The Engineering Lead weighs in where the change raises a technology or architecture question. | Within 2 days |
| <hr/> | | |
| 3 | Product Owner classifies it by size and risk, names the path, and the step it re-enters at: minor goes to Build, major goes to Assess. | Within 3 days of the request |
| <hr/> | | |
| 4 | Delivery engineer submits SG5 for a major change, or a CoE consult for any risk-flagged change, whatever its size. | Before the change moves |

A small change to something critical still takes the long route.

7 • Retire a solution

Owner: **Delivery engineer** Gate: **CoE decommission sign-off**

- | | | |
|-------|---|------------------------|
| 1 | Business confirms the solution is no longer needed, and why. | Same day it is flagged |
| <hr/> | | |
| 2 | Product Owner issues the decommission instruction and the agreed removal date. | Within 5 days |
| <hr/> | | |
| 3 | Engineers remove the assets, disable schedules, revoke access and archive the documentation. | On the removal date |
| <hr/> | | |
| 4 | Delivery engineer submits the sign-off and updates the estate register. | At CoE sign-off |

Retirement is a planned step on both routes, so the estate stays clean.

Size sets the support

Every piece of work gets a T-shirt size at intake, confirmed at SG1. The size tells you how much build to expect, how many scenarios the business checks live, and how long hypercare runs.

SIZE	RPA BUILD (IA)	POWER PLATFORM BUILD (SA)	SCENARIOS CHECKED LIVE	HYPERCARE
XS	One process, one system · 5 days or under	One form or one flow · 3 days or under	1 to 2	3 working days
S	One process, one or two systems · 1 to 2 weeks	App plus a few flows · about 1 week	3 to 5	5 working days
M	Two to four systems, exception handling · 3 to 4 weeks	Multi-screen app over Dataverse · 2 to 3 weeks	6 to 10	10 working days
L	Multi-system, queues, orchestration · 6 to 8 weeks	Multi-app solution with integrations · 5 to 6 weeks	11 to 20	15 working days
XL	Multi-process programme · 10 weeks or more	Enterprise solution across environments · 8 weeks or more	21 or more	20 working days

Hypercare is a fixed window. First-run checks (FOV) are not: they finish when every scenario has been checked and reconciled, however long that takes. Nothing scales beyond the checked scenarios until then.

Six rules we don't bend

- 1** All work comes in through intake. No side doors.
- 2** No build starts until the assessment is approved and the business has signed off the requirements and process map.
- 3** Nothing reaches production without evidenced testing and CoE approval.
- 4** Nothing scales until every scenario has passed its first live run.
- 5** Every change to a live solution is classified by size and risk before it moves.
- 6** The business accepts ownership before hypercare closes.

Where things get said

Each piece of work gets a Teams channel at intake. The Product Owner owns the pinned post and updates it at every gate. There are three meetings and no side channels.

Daily sync · Engineers, EL, PO

Progress, blockers, defects, first-run coverage and hypercare status.

Weekly feature sync · POs and ELs, cross-squad

Gate status and any slippage, called out in the week it appears.

Planning & prioritisation · leads and leadership

Portfolio priority, escalations, benefit and capacity.

Escalation

Technical blockers and stack questions go to the Engineering Lead. Scope, priority and business blockers go to the Product Owner. A missed timing goes to the daily sync, slippage to the feature sync. A failed gate, or a P1 or P2 defect, goes to leads at planning and prioritisation, with the date impact.

IA Intelligent Automation (RPA) **SA** Smart Automation (Power Platform) **CoE** Centre of Excellence **SG** Stage gate **UAT** User acceptance testing

F0V First Occurrence Validation, the first-run checks **BAU** Business as usual **P1 / P2** Highest-severity defects